



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Chicken

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Chicken

FRESH



1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)



up to 12 months frozen at 0°F

WOW

Frozen chicken can last up to 12 months with good quality, far longer than just a couple of days fresh.

Safety: Store frozen chicken at 0°F (-18°C) or below to maintain safety and quality.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Winter squash (Butternut)

Preserved by: stored cured, cool and dry

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Winter squash (Butternut)

FRESH

2-3 months stored at 50-55°F

PRESERVED (stored cured, cool and dry)

6-12 months dried or canned

WOW

Properly cured winter squash lasts months unrefrigerated, often longer than canned or frozen versions kept improperly.

Safety: Store squash in dry, well-ventilated area away from ripening fruit to avoid shortening shelf life.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Tomato sauce

Preserved by: home canned

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Tomato sauce

FRESH

3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned)

up to 12 months canned in a cool, dark place

WOW

Home canned tomato sauce can last up to a year, much longer than fresh sauce in the fridge.

Safety: Store jars in a cool, dark, dry place; inspect jars before use for spoilage signs.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Lemon curd

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Lemon curd

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))



3-4 months canned, or up to 1 year frozen

WOW

Canned lemon curd lasts only a few months, but frozen curd keeps quality up to a year.

Safety: Discard any lemon curd showing browning or separation; freeze promptly after cooling for extended storage.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Smoked Seafood

Preserved by: refrigerated, smoked

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Smoked Seafood

FRESH

1-3 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED (refrigerated, smoked)

2-3 weeks refrigerated smoked

WOW

Smoked seafood lasts only a few weeks refrigerated, much shorter than frozen seafood, despite the smoking process.

Safety: Smoked seafood is perishable and should not be refrigerated longer than 2-3 weeks; freezing is recommended for longer storage.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Peaches

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Peaches

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months home canned

WOW

Fresh peaches last only days refrigerated, but canned peaches can keep best quality for over a year.

Safety: Store home canned peaches in a cool, dark place; exposure to heat or light reduces quality and shelf life.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Elderberry Jam

Preserved by: home canned high-sugar jam

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-07

Elderberry Jam

FRESH

1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned high-sugar jam)

12 months home canned

WOW

Elderberry jam must have a high sugar ratio to be safe when canned; the sugar keeps bad bacteria from growing.

Safety: Follow exact sugar ratios and processing times when making elderberry jams to prevent botulism risk.

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries



HL-08

HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pears

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pears

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months home canned

WOW

Home canned pears can be stored safely up to 18 months, but fresh pears spoil in under a week even refrigerated.

Safety: Store canned pears in cool, dry conditions away from heat and light for best quality.

Source: SP 50-678 Preserving pears



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Plums

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-09

Plums

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months home canned

WOW

Fresh plums go bad in under a week refrigerated, but canned plums stay good for over a year.

Safety: Keep canned plums away from direct heat or freezing to maintain shelf life and quality.

Source: SP 50-586 Preserving plums and prunes



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Berries

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-10

Berries

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12 months home canned

WOW

Though berries are very perishable fresh, canned berries can remain good quality for a full year.

Safety: Store home canned berries in cool, dark, dry conditions to prevent spoilage and quality loss.

Source: SP 50-780 Preserving berries



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh tomatoes

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh tomatoes

FRESH

about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Home canned tomatoes last over a year, vastly outlasting their fresh refrigerated life.

Safety: Use tested recipes and process tomato products in a pressure canner at recommended pressures and times.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh salsa (homemade refrigerator)

*Preserved by: home canned salsa (boiling
water canner)*

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-12

Fresh salsa (homemade refrigerator)

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned salsa (boiling water canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Though fresh salsa spoils in days, the same ingredients canned properly last over a year safely.

Safety: Boiling water canning with tested recipes is critical; process times depend on altitude and acidity.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Spaghetti sauce without meat

*Preserved by: home canned (pressure
canner)*

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Spaghetti sauce without meat

FRESH

about 5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Canned spaghetti sauce made without meat keeps safely over a year, much longer than fresh sauce in the fridge.

Safety: Do not increase proportion of low acid vegetables; process in a pressure canner at 20-25 minutes depending on jar size.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Tomato salsa (using paste tomatoes)

*Preserved by: home canned (boiling water
canner)*

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-14

Tomato salsa (using paste tomatoes)

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Tomato salsa made with paste tomatoes lasts a few days fresh but over a year canned safely.

Safety: Use tested recipes and vinegar levels; process 15-25 minutes in boiling water canner based on altitude.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Tomatoes with okra or zucchini

*Preserved by: home canned (pressure
canner)*

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Tomatoes with okra or zucchini

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Adding okra or zucchini to canned tomatoes does not shorten shelf life if processed properly.

Safety: Process in pressure canner; added vegetables require careful adherence to tested recipes and processing times.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Green Beans

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Green Beans

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Home-canned green beans last almost 3 years safe, far longer than fresh refrigerated beans last about a week.

Safety: Use pressure canning to destroy Clostridium botulinum spores; boiling water canner is unsafe for low acid vegetables.

Source: SP 50-445 Preserving green italian or wax beans



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Sweet Corn

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Sweet Corn

FRESH

1-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Fresh sweet corn loses quality within days, but home-canned corn stays good and safe for about 1.5 years.

Safety: Always use pressure canning for corn to prevent botulism; refrigerator storage extends freshness only a few days.

Source: SP 50-443 Preserving corn



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Peas

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Peas

FRESH

2-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)

8-12 months frozen

WOW

Freezing fresh peas preserves their best quality for almost a year, far longer than just a few days fresh.

Safety: Freeze promptly after blanching for best quality; freezing does not kill all microbes but stops their growth.

Source: SP 50-305 Preserving peas edible pea pods



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pumpkin (cubed)

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pumpkin (cubed)

FRESH



3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)



10-12 months frozen

WOW

Cubed pumpkin freezes well for nearly a year, significantly extending its use beyond just a few days fresh.

Safety: Blanch cubes before freezing for best quality; frozen pumpkin remains safe past quality loss if kept frozen.

Source: SP 50-767 Preserving pumpkins winter squash



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Garlic

Preserved by: frozen chopped

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Garlic

FRESH

1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen chopped)

3-6 months frozen

WOW

Fresh garlic can last about a week refrigerated, but freezing chopped garlic keeps its flavor safe up to half a year.

Safety: Use airtight containers or vacuum sealing for freezing to avoid freezer burn; garlic in oil must be refrigerated and used quickly.

Source: SP 50-645 Preserving garlic



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Cucumbers (pickled)

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Cucumbers (pickled)

FRESH

about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

up to 1 year stored in a cool, dark, dry place

WOW

Pickled cucumbers can last up to a year, vastly outliving their fresh lifespan of about a week.

Safety: Store jars in a cool, dark, dry place; remove screw bands to prevent rusting; use proper vinegar acidity to prevent bacterial growth.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Bread and Butter Pickles

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Bread and Butter Pickles

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

up to 1 year in pantry storage

WOW

Bread and Butter Pickles transform fresh zucchini or cucumbers lasting days into a pantry staple lasting a year or more.

Safety: Use proper vinegar concentration and processing times; keep stored away from heat and light to preserve quality.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pickled Hot Peppers

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pickled Hot Peppers

FRESH

about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

up to 1 year shelf stable

WOW

Hot peppers, though fresh for just a week, become shelf stable for up to a year once pickled correctly.

Safety: Wear gloves handling hot peppers; process in boiling water bath according to altitude and jar size to ensure safety.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fermented Sauerkraut

Preserved by: fermentation (brined)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fermented Sauerkraut

FRESH

fresh cabbage lasts 2-3 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (fermentation (brined))

fermented sauerkraut can last for 4-6 months refrigerated

WOW

Fermented sauerkraut lasts many months longer than fresh cabbage thanks to friendly bacteria producing acid.

Safety: Keep sauerkraut submerged in brine during fermentation; store refrigerated to prevent spoilage.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pickled Onions

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pickled Onions

FRESH

fresh onions last 1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

up to 1 year shelf stable

WOW

Pickled onions keep safe and tasty for up to a year, while fresh onions spoil within a couple of weeks.

Safety: Use approved pickling recipe with sufficient vinegar; process jars fully to prevent spoilage and botulism risk.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Strawberry Freezer Jam

Preserved by: frozen (freezer)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Strawberry Freezer Jam

FRESH

1-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen (freezer))

up to 1 year frozen

WOW

Freezing jams preserves both flavor and texture much longer than refrigerating fresh jam, which spoils quickly.

Safety: Freezer jams are not heat processed; must be kept frozen or refrigerated and used within recommended times.

Source: SP 50-763 Uncooked freezer jams



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Grape Jam

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Grape Jam

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months home canned

WOW

Properly canned grape jam can last over a year, far longer than fresh jam which spoils in less than a week.

Safety: Follow exact canning times and headspace recommendations precisely to ensure safety and avoid spoilage.

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Blackberry Jelly

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Blackberry Jelly

FRESH

2-4 days refrigerated fresh juice/jelly

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months home canned jelly

WOW

Blackberry jelly, when canned properly, can keep safely for over a year, in contrast to fresh juice which spoils in a few days.

Safety: Use only tested recipes and ensure jelly reaches gelling point and process times to maintain safety.

Source: SP 50-777 Jams jellies preserves with no added pectin



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

No-Sugar Added Fruit Spread

Preserved by: home canned (water bath, low sugar recipes)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



No-Sugar Added Fruit Spread

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath, low sugar recipes))

6-12 months home canned low sugar

WOW

Low sugar fruit spreads require careful processing and have a shorter shelf life than traditional jams with high sugar.

Safety: Low sugar spreads need tested recipes and proper acidification to ensure safety during canning.

Source: SP 50-765 Low sugar fruit spreads



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

High-Sugar Elderberry Jam

Preserved by: home canned (water bath, high sugar ratio)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



High-Sugar Elderberry Jam

FRESH

3-4 days refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath, high sugar ratio))

12-18 months home canned high sugar jam

WOW

Elderberry jams must have very high sugar levels to be safely canned because of their low natural acidity.

Safety: Must strictly follow sugar-to-juice ratios and processing times to prevent risk from botulism.

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Mushrooms

Preserved by: refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Mushrooms

FRESH

1-3 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (refrigerated)

up to 12 months frozen

WOW

Fresh mushrooms only last a couple days refrigerated, but they can be frozen up to a year for long storage.

Safety: Keep mushrooms dry and store in refrigerator to delay spoilage; freeze if storing long term.

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Eggs

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Eggs

FRESH

3-5 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated)

months to years stored in water glass (lime water)

WOW

Storing eggs in water glass can preserve them for many months, far longer than typical refrigeration.

Safety: Commercial eggs are washed and must be refrigerated; improper storage or washing decreases shelf life.

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Fish (Salmon)

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Fish (Salmon)

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated)

up to 3 months frozen

WOW

Fresh salmon spoils fast in the fridge but can keep good quality only up to 3 months frozen.

Safety: Freeze at 0°F or colder; avoid slow freezing to reduce ice crystal damage; cook immediately after thawing.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Cooked Meat Casserole

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Cooked Meat Casserole

FRESH

3-4 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)

4-6 months frozen

WOW

A cooked meat casserole lasts just days in the fridge but can be kept frozen for half a year.

Safety: Freeze promptly in airtight packaging; store at 0°F or lower for best quality.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Acorn squash

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Acorn squash

FRESH

1-2 months in cool storage at 50-55°F

PRESERVED (frozen)

8-12 months frozen at 0°F

WOW

Acorn squash lasts just 1-2 months fresh in cool storage but can be frozen and retain quality for up to a year.

Safety: Store fresh squash at 50-55°F to avoid rapid deterioration; freezing stops spoilage but quality declines if frozen too long.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Beef Jerky

Preserved by: dried

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Beef Jerky

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (dried)

1-2 months at room temperature, up to 6 months refrigerated, or 1 year frozen

WOW

Homemade beef jerky can last almost a year if frozen, vastly outlasting fresh meat's brief refrigerated life.

Safety: Store jerky in a cool, dark, dry place; discard if mold appears.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Smoked Sausage

Preserved by: smoked

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Smoked Sausage

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (smoked)

2-3 weeks refrigerated vacuum sealed

WOW

Smoking extends sausage shelf life modestly-weeks, not months-so refrigeration remains essential.

Safety: Keep smoked sausage refrigerated and vacuum-sealed for best quality and safety.

Source: SP 50-735 Summer sausage deli style meats



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Dried Herbs

Preserved by: dried

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Dried Herbs

FRESH

1-2 weeks fresh at room temperature

PRESERVED (dried)

1-3 years dried in airtight container

WOW

Dry herbs retain flavor and safety for years, while fresh herbs spoil in days.

Safety: Store dried herbs in airtight containers away from light and moisture for best quality.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Smoked Bacon

Preserved by: smoked and cured

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Smoked Bacon

FRESH

1 week refrigerated fresh

PRESERVED (smoked and cured)

1-2 months refrigerated smoked and cured

WOW

Smoking combined with curing roughly triples the shelf life of bacon under refrigeration.

Safety: Keep smoked bacon refrigerated and use within recommended time; discard if off odor or slime appear.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Dried Peppers

Preserved by: dried

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Dried Peppers

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (dried)

6 months to 1 year dried in airtight container

WOW

Dried peppers last many months at room temperature, far longer than fresh ones which spoil in weeks.

Safety: Store dried peppers in a cool, dry, dark place in sealed containers to prevent spoilage.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables